

Industry Standards & Agency Breakdown Cheat Sheet

A quick-reference guide designed to help you understand where your look may fit best within the modelling industry.

HOW TO GET SIGNED!
The Model-Ready System

01 - Understanding Agency Levels

Agency tiers are not official rankings. They are a practical way to understand how agencies are generally positioned within the industry. Use them as a strategy guide, not as a fixed rule.

Agency level	Usually focused on	Best suited for	Examples
Elite tier	Luxury fashion, runway, editorials, global campaigns	High fashion, editorial, runway, luxury campaign talent	IMG Models, Elite Model Management, Women Management, Next Management, DNA Models, The Society Management
High tier	Fashion, commercial, beauty, lifestyle, e-commerce, editorial crossover	Fashion-commercial models, new faces, lifestyle talent, beauty campaigns	Storm Management, Select Model Management, Premier Model Management, Models 1, Wilhelmina Models
Commercial tier	Advertising, e-commerce, retail, lifestyle campaigns, digital campaigns	Commercial models, e-commerce models, fitness models, lifestyle talent	BMA Models, Base Models, W Model Management, Sandra Reynolds, Nemesis Models, State Management, MMG Models

02 - Global Market Breakdown

Market	Known for	Best for
London	Fashion and commercial crossover, individuality, editorial creativity, streetwear influence, strong personal identity	Fashion-commercial models, commercial models, lifestyle talent, editorial talent, unique faces
Paris	Luxury fashion, editorial prestige, high fashion dominance, designer houses, elegant presentation	High fashion, editorial, runway, luxury fashion talent
Milan	Designer campaigns, tailoring, luxury fashion, runway, classic fashion structure	Runway, high fashion, editorial, luxury campaigns
New York	Commercial versatility, fashion and lifestyle blend, beauty, digital influence, market diversity	Commercial models, fashion-commercial crossover, editorial, lifestyle, beauty, fitness

03 - Agency Breakdown By City

London Agencies

Agency	Specialises in	Tier	Known for
Storm Management	Fashion / Commercial	High tier	Strong UK fashion presence, model discovery, editorial and commercial talent
Models 1	Commercial / Fashion	High tier	Recognised UK agency with fashion, commercial and talent divisions
Premier Model Management	Runway / Editorial	High tier	London fashion agency with editorial, runway and new faces talent
Select Model Management	Editorial / Lifestyle	High tier	Fashion-commercial crossover with international offices
BMA Models	Commercial / Lifestyle	Commercial tier	Diverse commercial, curve, influencer and talent representation
Base Models	Commercial / Fitness	Commercial tier	Commercial, lifestyle, sports and fitness talent
W Model Management	Fitness / Commercial	Commercial tier	Fitness, sports, physique and wellness-led talent
Milk Management	Fashion / Curve / Digital	High tier	Diverse fashion, digital, broadcast and curve representation
Established Models	Editorial / Commercial	High tier	Fashion, beauty and commercial placements
Anti-Agency	Alternative / Fashion	High tier	Unconventional, character-driven and culturally relevant talent
Sandra Reynolds	Commercial / Lifestyle	Commercial tier	Commercial campaigns, family, lifestyle, classic and real people talent

Paris Agencies

Agency	Specialises in	Tier	Known for
IMG Models Paris	Luxury / Editorial	Elite tier	Global fashion representation, runway and luxury campaigns
Elite Model Management Paris	High fashion / Editorial	Elite tier	Iconic international fashion agency with strong editorial heritage
Women Management Paris	Luxury fashion	Elite tier	Luxury fashion, editorial and high-fashion positioning
Next Management Paris	Fashion / Editorial	Elite tier	International fashion and entertainment management
Ford Models Paris	Fashion / Commercial	High tier	Fashion-commercial crossover and international talent
Metropolitan Models	Editorial / Commercial	High tier	Paris-based agency with international editorial presence
Silent Models Paris	Fashion / Editorial	High tier	Contemporary editorial and high-fashion talent
Karin Models	Fashion / Beauty	High tier	Beauty, editorial and fashion placements
Success Models	Men / Fashion	High tier	Strong male fashion and editorial representation
Viva Paris	Fashion / Editorial	High tier	Editorial talent and international fashion representation
Premium Models	Fashion / Commercial	High tier	Fashion and commercial placements in the Paris market

Milan Agencies

Agency	Specialises in	Tier	Known for
Why Not Model Management	Runway / Editorial	High tier	Strong Milan fashion week and designer campaign presence
IMG Models Milan	Editorial / Runway	Elite tier	Luxury runway and global campaigns
Elite Model Management Milan	Luxury fashion	Elite tier	Runway, editorial and fashion week representation
Women Management Milan	High fashion	Elite tier	Luxury fashion and high-fashion editorial talent
Next Management Milan	Fashion / Editorial	Elite tier	Global fashion management with Milan market reach
Fashion Model Management	Editorial / Fashion	High tier	Milan fashion, editorial and designer campaigns
Major Model Management Milan	Fashion / Editorial	High tier	European fashion market presence and editorial development
Monster Management	Fashion / Commercial	High tier	Contemporary fashion, commercial and creative talent
Independent Model Management	Editorial / Commercial	High tier	Fashion and commercial talent in Milan
Brave Model Management	Fashion / Men	High tier	Strong male board and fashion positioning

New York Agencies

Agency	Specialises in	Tier	Known for
IMG Models New York	Editorial / Runway	Elite tier	One of the most powerful global fashion agencies
Ford Models	Commercial / Fashion	Elite tier	Historic agency with fashion, commercial and talent divisions
Wilhelmina Models	Commercial / Fitness	High tier	Commercial, beauty, fashion and sports/fitness divisions
DNA Model Management	High fashion	Elite tier	Editorial, runway and high-fashion talent
The Society Management	Luxury fashion	Elite tier	High-fashion, beauty, pop culture and digital crossover
Next Management New York	Fashion / Editorial	Elite tier	Global fashion and entertainment management
Women Management New York	Fashion / Editorial	Elite tier	Editorial and high-fashion representation
New York Models	Editorial / Fashion	High tier	Editorial, runway and commercial fashion presence
State Management	Fashion / Commercial	High tier	Commercial, fashion, lifestyle and digital talent
ONE Management	Fashion / Lifestyle	High tier	Fashion, lifestyle, influencer and creative talent
Muse Management	Fashion / Commercial	High tier	Fashion-commercial talent and development
MMG Model Management	Commercial / Lifestyle	Commercial tier	Commercial advertising, lifestyle and talent management

04 - Best Agency Alignment By Category

Category	Strong agency fits	Why this fit makes sense
High fashion / Editorial	IMG Models, Elite Model Management, Women Management, Next Management, DNA Models, The Society Management	These agencies are strongly connected to runway, editorial, luxury fashion and global campaigns.
Commercial / E-commerce	Models 1, BMA Models, Base Models, Sandra Reynolds, State Management, Ford Models, Wilhelmina Models	Commercial agencies usually prioritise relatability, versatility, lifestyle fit and brand usability.
Fitness	W Model Management, Base Models, Wilhelmina Fitness, Sports + Lifestyle Unlimited, commercial divisions at larger agencies	Fitness-focused representation often suits athletic physiques, activewear, wellness and sports campaigns.
Plus-size / Curve	Milk Management, Bridge Models, IMG Curve, Ford+, JAG Models, Dorothy Combs Models	Curve representation focuses on proportion, confidence, commercial appeal and fashion-market fit.
Alternative / Character	Anti-Agency, selected development boards, commercial lifestyle agencies	Best for distinctive looks, strong personality, creative markets and culturally relevant talent.
Parts / Beauty	Beauty divisions, commercial agencies, specialist parts agencies	Best for hands, skin, hair, lips and detail-focused beauty campaigns.

05 - Final Positioning Advice

Do not focus only on the biggest agency. Focus on the agency that best understands your look, category and market potential.

The strongest applications usually happen when your look, your positioning and the agency market all align clearly.

Key principle: strong positioning creates stronger opportunities.

Note: This resource is a strategic positioning guide. Agency tiers are not official rankings and may change over time. Always research the agency directly before applying.